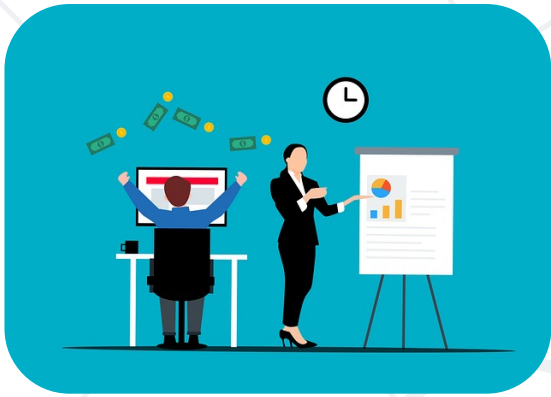


Introduction to IT Business Analysis

Role and Responsibilities



SoftUni Team
Technical Trainers



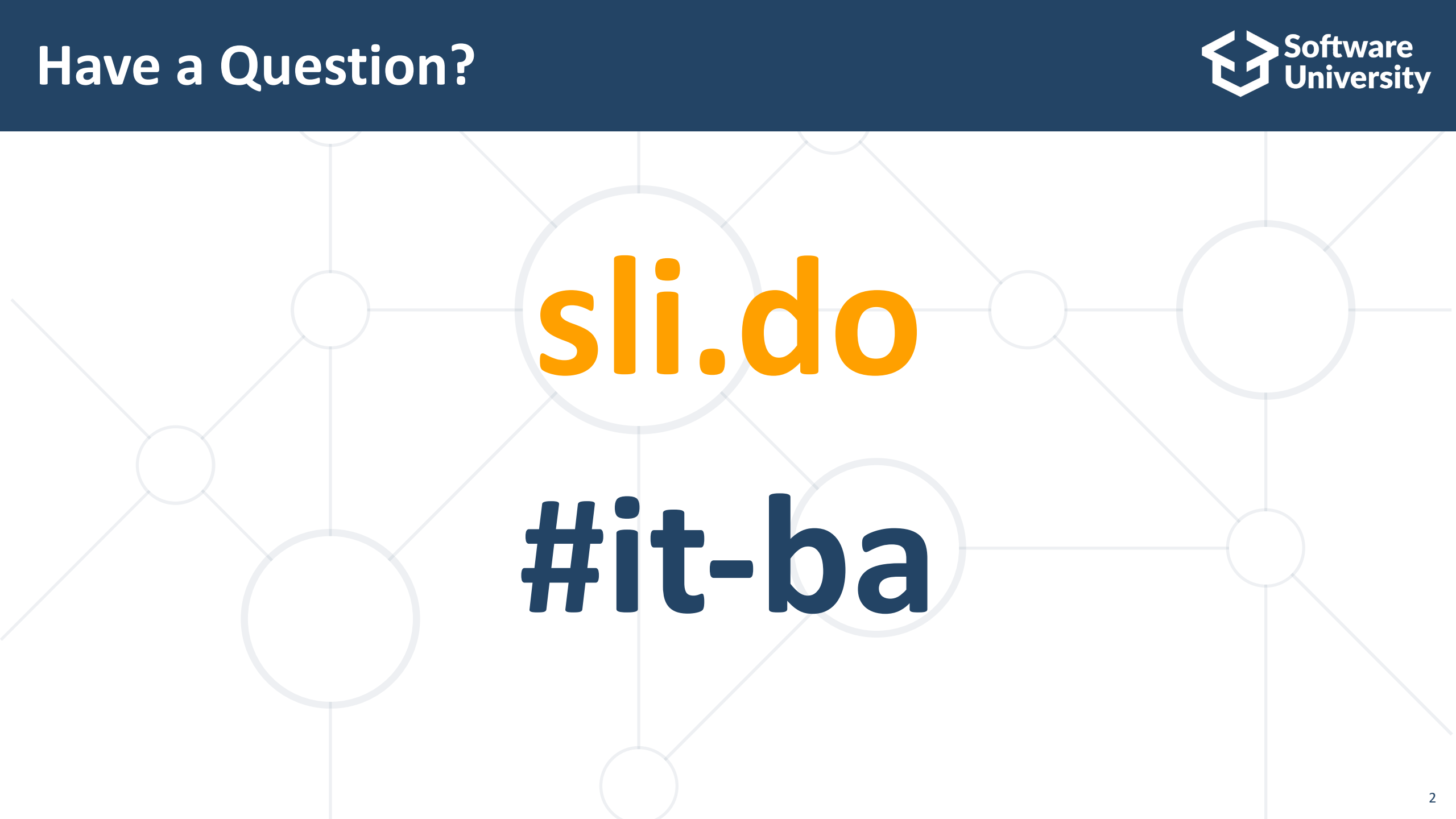
SoftUni



Software University

<https://about.softuni.bg>

Have a Question?



sli.do

#it-ba

- Course Overview
- Business and Ecosystem
- What is Business Analysis?
- Who is the Business Analyst?
- Business Analysis Challenges
- Root Cause Analysis
- Practice





Course Overview

Course Details



BA Fundamentals
course is consisted of
10 sessions



1 session per week



Each session ~ 3
hours with 15 min
breaks



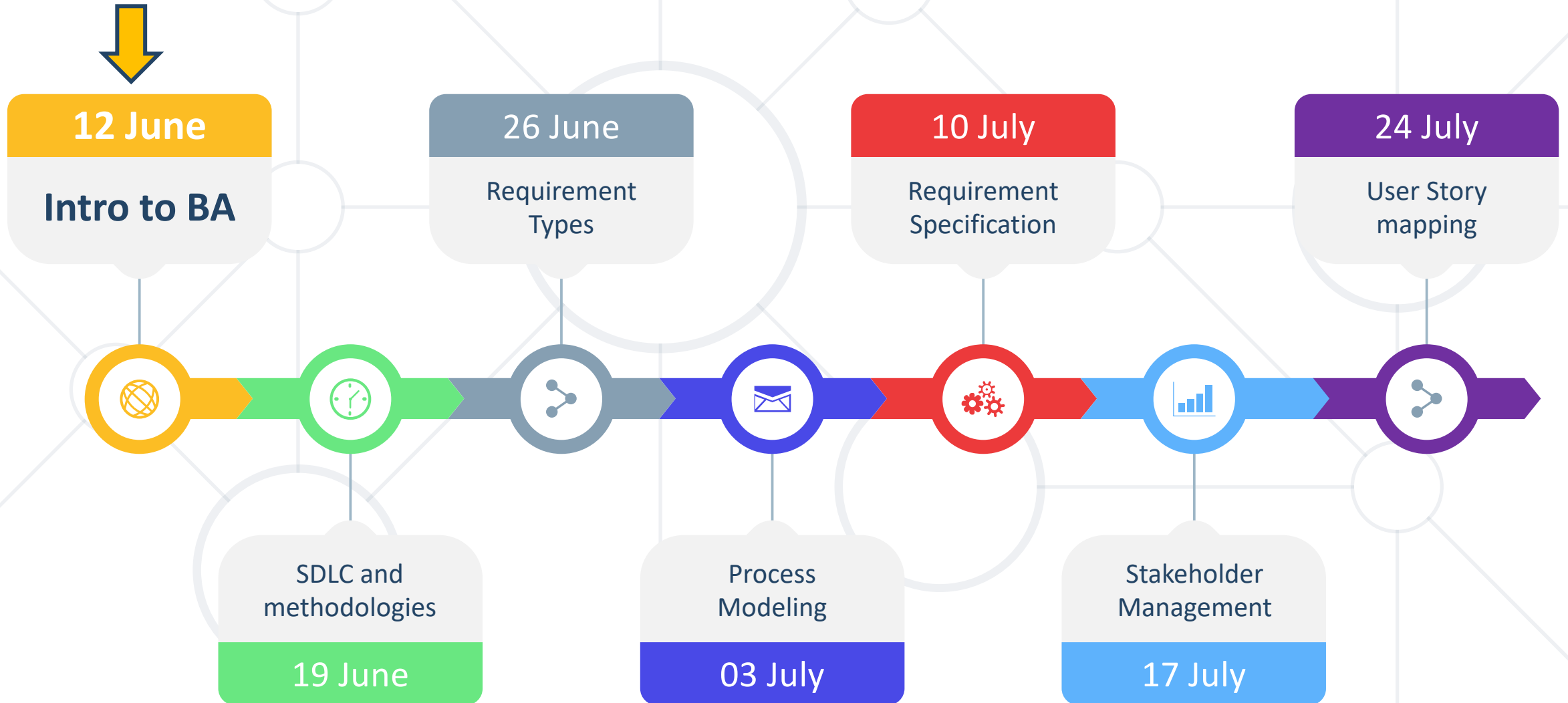
Exam – 18.08.2024



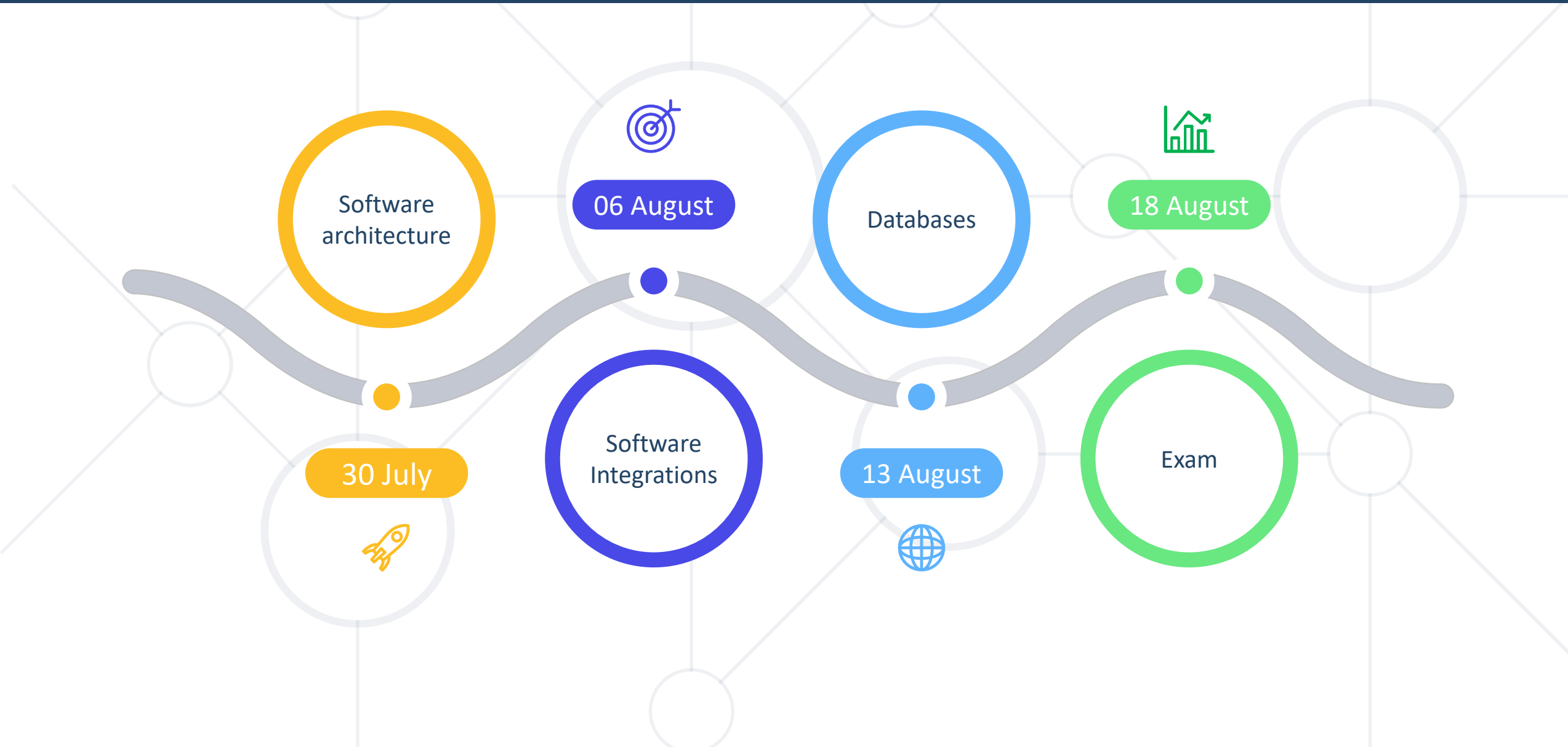
Final evaluation:
exam + homeworks



BA Sessions Timeline



Technical Sessions and Exam Timeline





Course Work Overview

Explanation and Overview



Business and Ecosystem

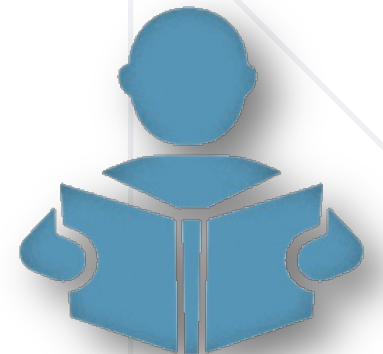
What is Business?

- **Definition:** Business is defined as an **organized economic activity**, wherein the exchange of **goods** and **services** takes place, for adequate consideration



What is Business Entity?

- A business entity refers to an **organization that is formed specifically** to conduct business
- It is a **legal entity** that is **separate** and **distinct** from its owners
- The term encompasses many types of structures, each with different implications for **liability**, **taxation**, and **regulation**
- Entity that is formed and administered to engage in **commercial activities** (for profit) or **non-commercial activities** (not for profit – charitable work)



Differences Between Organizations

Factor	Nonprofit	For Profit
Ownership	None (the public)	Stakeholders
Primary Mission	To provide services needed by society	To make a profit for shareholders
Secondary mission	To ensure there is surplus(revenues greater than expenses) so the nonprofit can continue its mission	To provide goods and services in a way that sustains the company
Revenue sources	Contributions, grants, membership dues, program revenue	Sales of products or services, investment income
Workforce	A mix of paid staff and volunteers	Paid employees
Accountability	Accountable to the public; must file annual information returns with the federal and state governments	Accountable to its shareholders; must file annual tax returns with the federal and state governments
Tax status	Exempt from income taxes	Corporation (owners) subject to income taxes

- Do you know profit and nonprofit organizations?

- Greenpeace

- IIBA

- Coca-Cola HBC



Coca-Cola
HBC

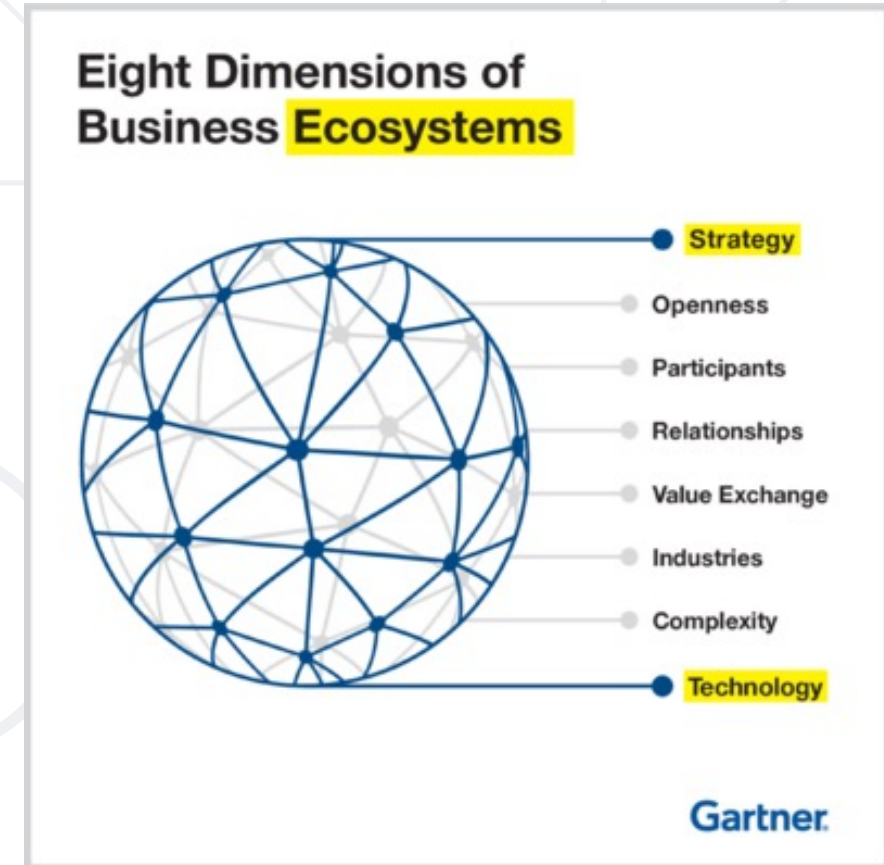




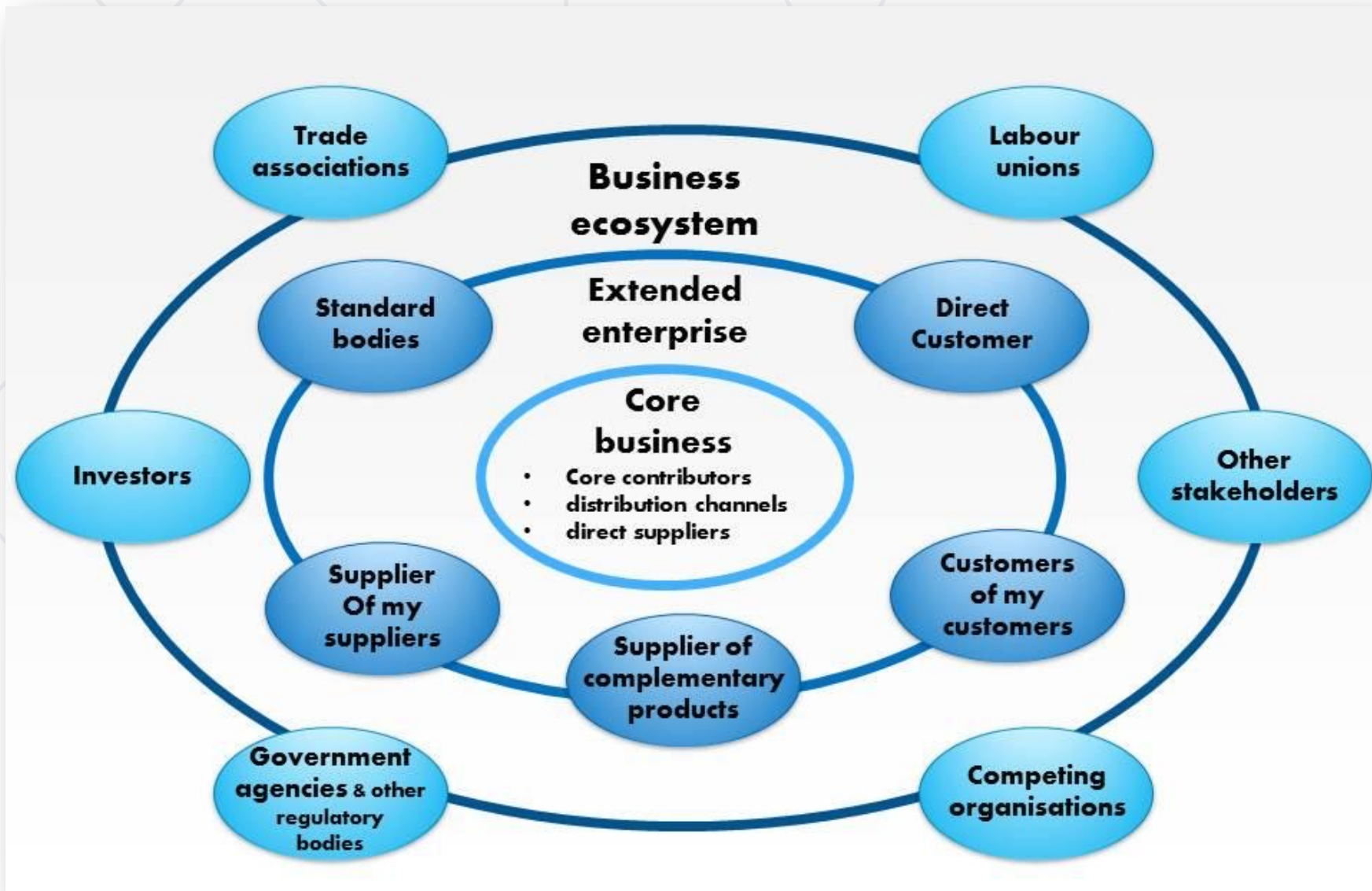
Business Ecosystem

or how to identify it..

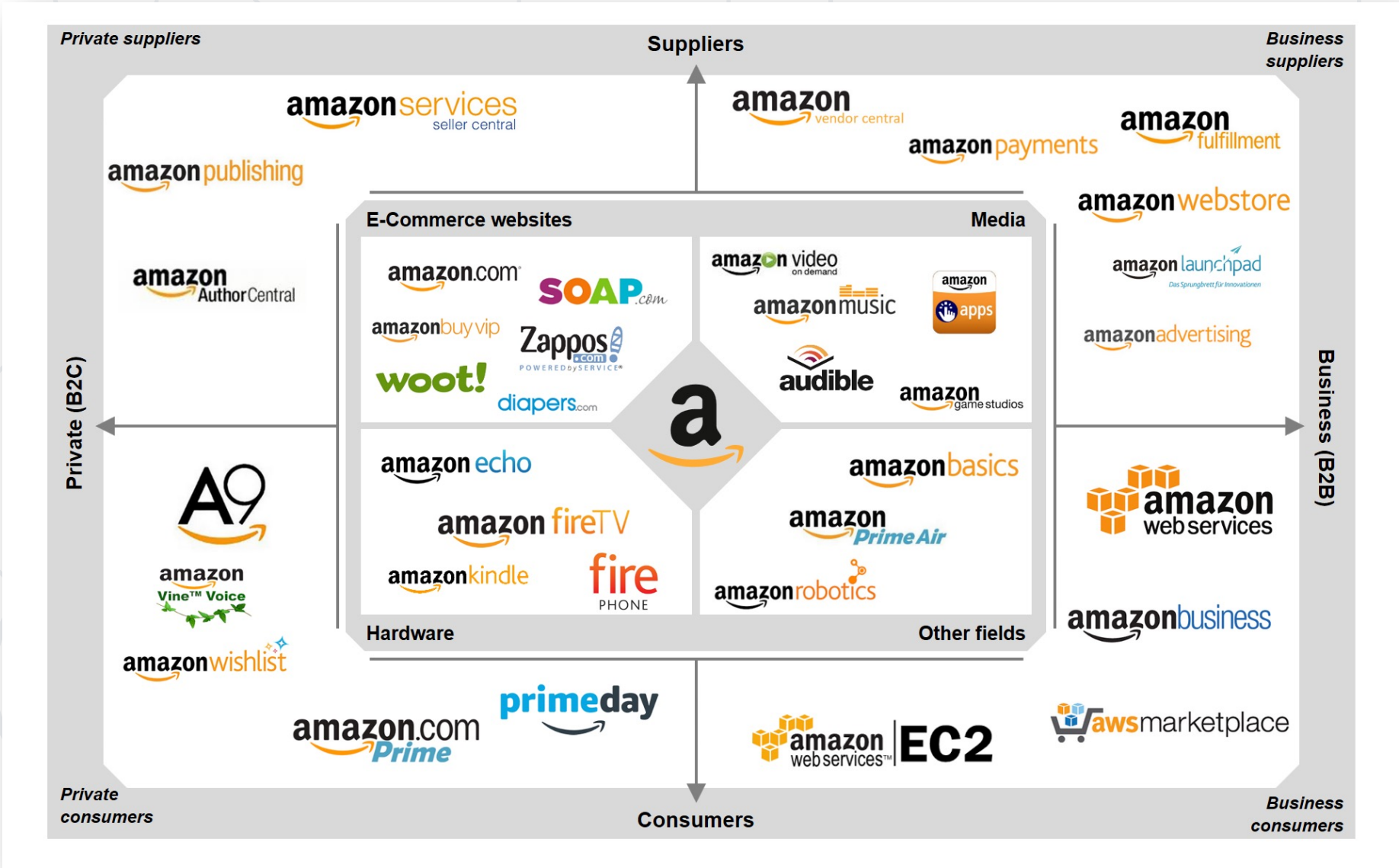
- A business ecosystem is the network of organizations (**suppliers, distributors, customers, competitors, government agencies**) involved in the delivery of a specific product or service through both competition and cooperation



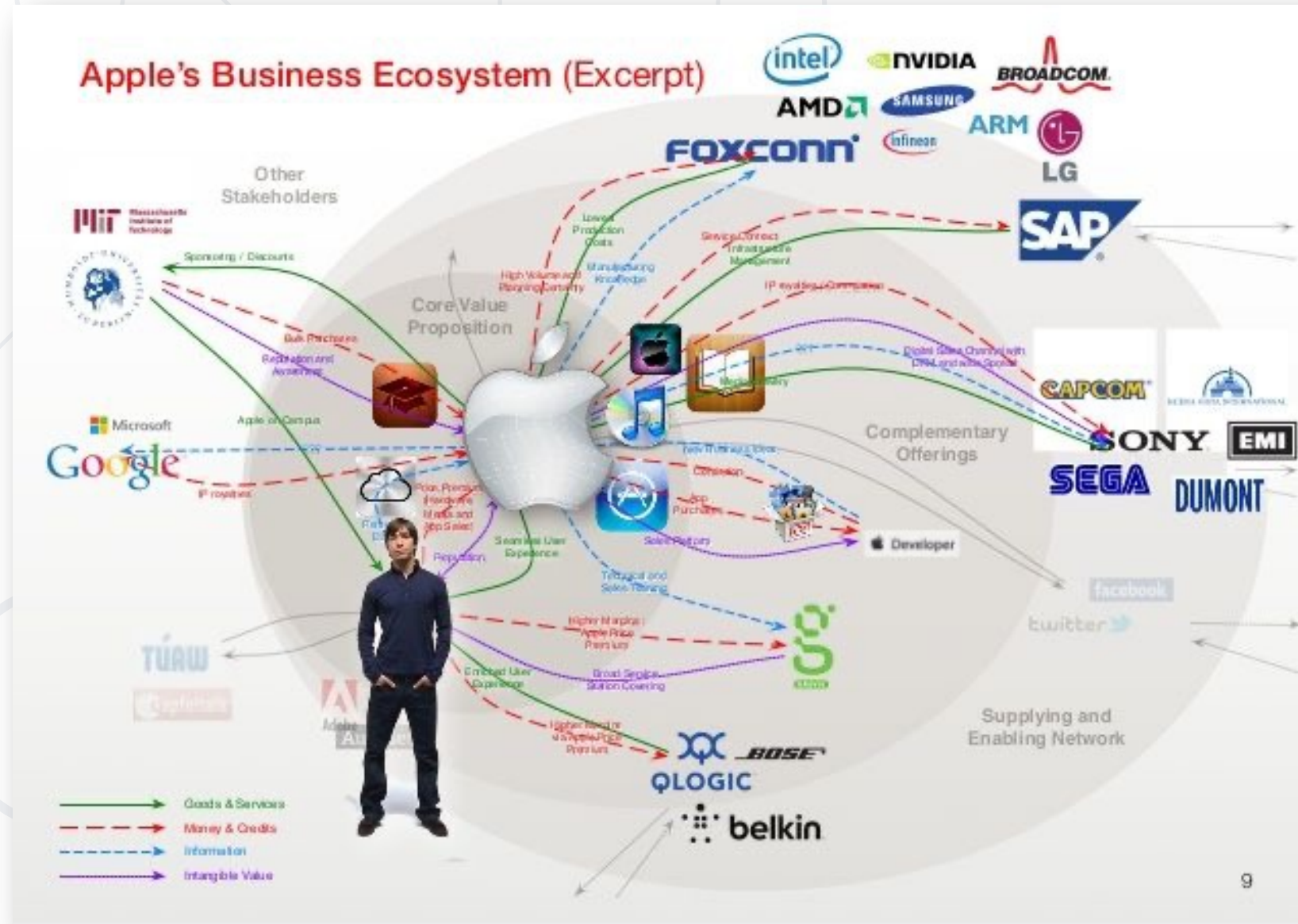
Business Ecosystem



Business Ecosystem



Business Ecosystem





What is Business Analysis?

What is Business Analysis?



- "**Business Analysis** is the practice of enabling change in an enterprise by defining needs and recommending solutions that deliver value to the stakeholders." - *BABOK guide V3*

Business Analysis Examples

Business Analysis is a versatile field encompassing various techniques and practices. Here are five **Business Analysis Examples**:

- **Strategic planning**: A Business Analyst evaluates a company's strategic direction and identifies initiatives to achieve business goals. For example, they might analyze market trends to guide the company's product development strategy.
- **Requirements management**: Analysts gather and manage stakeholder requirements for a new software system. They ensure the final product aligns with user needs and business objectives, often using tools like case models.



Business Analysis Examples



- **Process Design**: Business Analysts redesign an organization's workflow to improve efficiency. They might map out current processes and suggest improvements, such as automating manual tasks.
- **Data Analysis**: Analysts use data to drive business decisions. For instance, they might analyze customer data to identify buying patterns and inform marketing strategies.
- **Change Management**: When a company implements a new technology, Business Analysts help manage the transition. They plan and oversee the change process, ensuring minimal disruption and aligning new systems with business strategies.

History of Business Analysis



- As a practice within an organization, it started in the **1940s** when the first programmable computer was birthed
- Then, the use of computer systems was primarily by the government, universities and the organizations that invented them
- Data storage was enhanced user-friendly programs and interfaces were invented
- At first, **Business Analysts were usually called Systems Analysts** and the role was typically focused on software engineering
- Therefore, in order to support the business model, **the role of the Business Analyst had to be developed** and has done so over the last twenty years

IIBA® (International Institute of Business Analysis™) is an association for business analysts that is dedicated to the advancement of the Business Analysis profession by setting and maintaining global standards for the practice and certification.

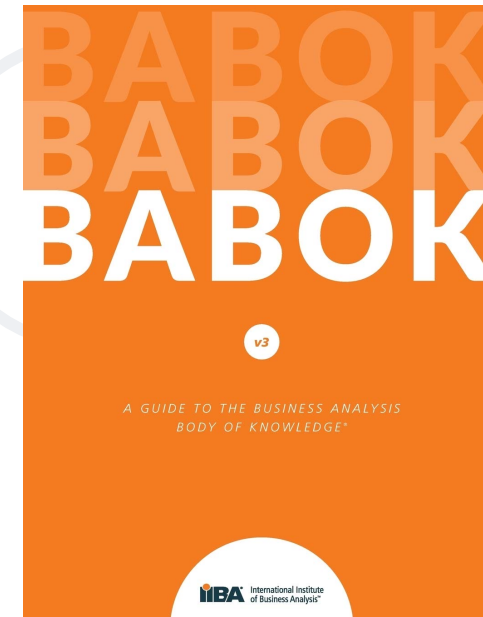
In 2003, the International Institute of Business Analysis was founded as an independent **non-profit professional association**.

Some of its objectives were to:

- **act as the voice of the business analysis community,**
- **support the recognition of the profession**
- **maintain standards for the practice and certification and,**
- **provide the resources to help individuals enhance and advance their career path**

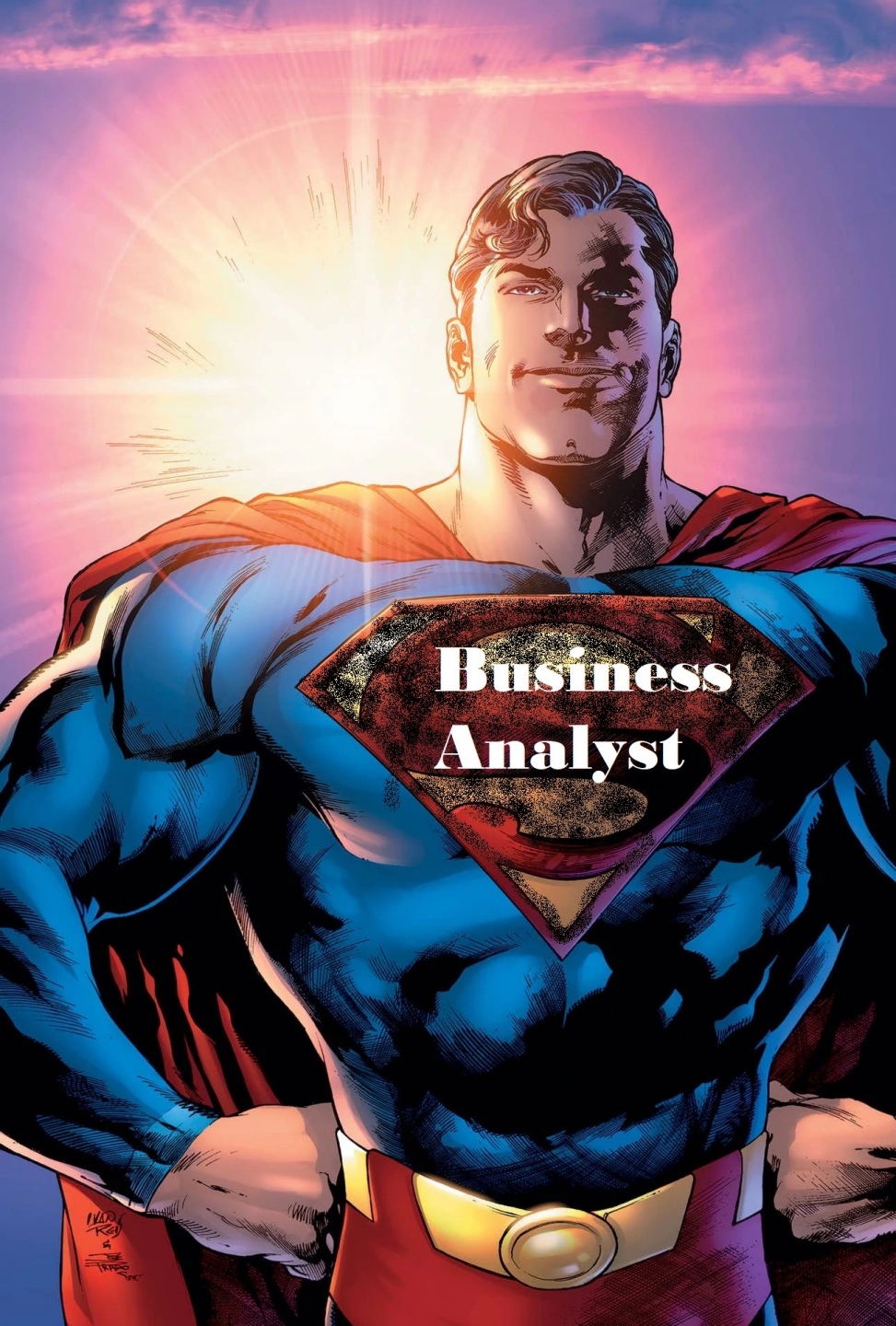
Learn more: [**History of IIBA**](#)

- Body of knowledge committee was **formed in 2004**
- In 2005, the BABOK guide was released and the **CBAP certification program** was implemented
- Members of the institute grew to over 5,000 members by 2008, and to 16,000 in 2011
- As of 2023, **IIBA connects almost 30,000** members, encompassing over 100 chapters and more than 500 partners globally



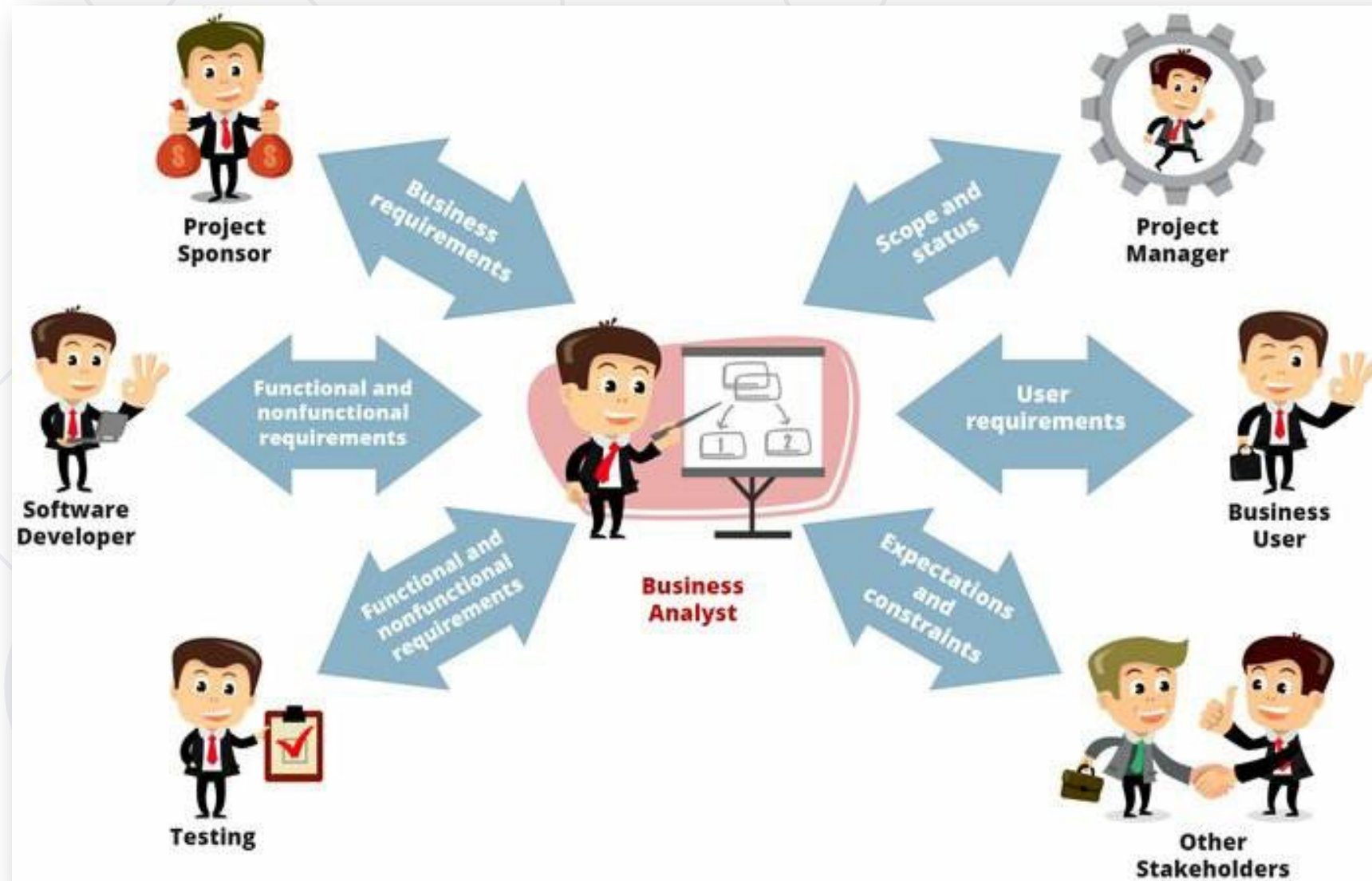


Who is the Business Analyst?



- **"A business analyst** is any person who performs business analysis tasks, no matter their job title or organizational role."
- "Business analysts are responsible for **discovering, synthesizing, and analyzing information** from a variety of sources within the enterprise, including tools, processes, documentation, and stakeholders."
- "The business analyst is responsible for **eliciting the actual needs** of stakeholders."

Business Analyst – Central Role in the Team



Roles and Responsibilities

- Business Analysts are responsible for **understanding business needs** and **assessing the impact** of changes
- They **analyze** and document requirements, **develop** business cases, and **act as** the key liaison between stakeholders
- Here are some of **the Roles and Responsibilities of a Business Analyst**:
 - Identifying areas for improvement within Business Processes
 - Researching and implementing new systems or modifications
 - Present findings and collaborate with teams to execute solutions
 - Ensuring that solutions meet business needs and requirements



Business Analyst in a Software Development Project



Skills Required to be a Business Analyst

- A successful Business Analyst typically possesses a **mix of technical and soft skills**
- Here are some **Business Analyst Skills**:
 - Analytical skills for effective **problem-solving**
 - **Communication** skills to articulate findings and rally support
 - **Technical knowledge** in Data Analysis tools like SQL and Excel
 - Project **lifecycle understanding** to oversee project progress
 - **Agile** and **Abstract** thinking to be able to assess the full solution and risk on time



Qualifications Required to be a Business Analyst

Here are the various requirements to fulfil the list of **Qualifications for the role of a Business Analyst:**

- A bachelor's degree in business or a related field
- Relevant work experience in business or IT
- Optional but beneficial certifications like the Entry Certificate in Business Analysis (ECBA)





Business Analysis Challenges

BA Challenges

Business Analysis (BA) is a critical function in organizations but comes with challenges. Here are some common hurdles faced by Business Analysts:

- **Lack of domain knowledge**
- **Evolving business needs**
- **Communication gaps**
- **Resistance to change**
- **Complex stakeholder management**



BA Challenges Overview

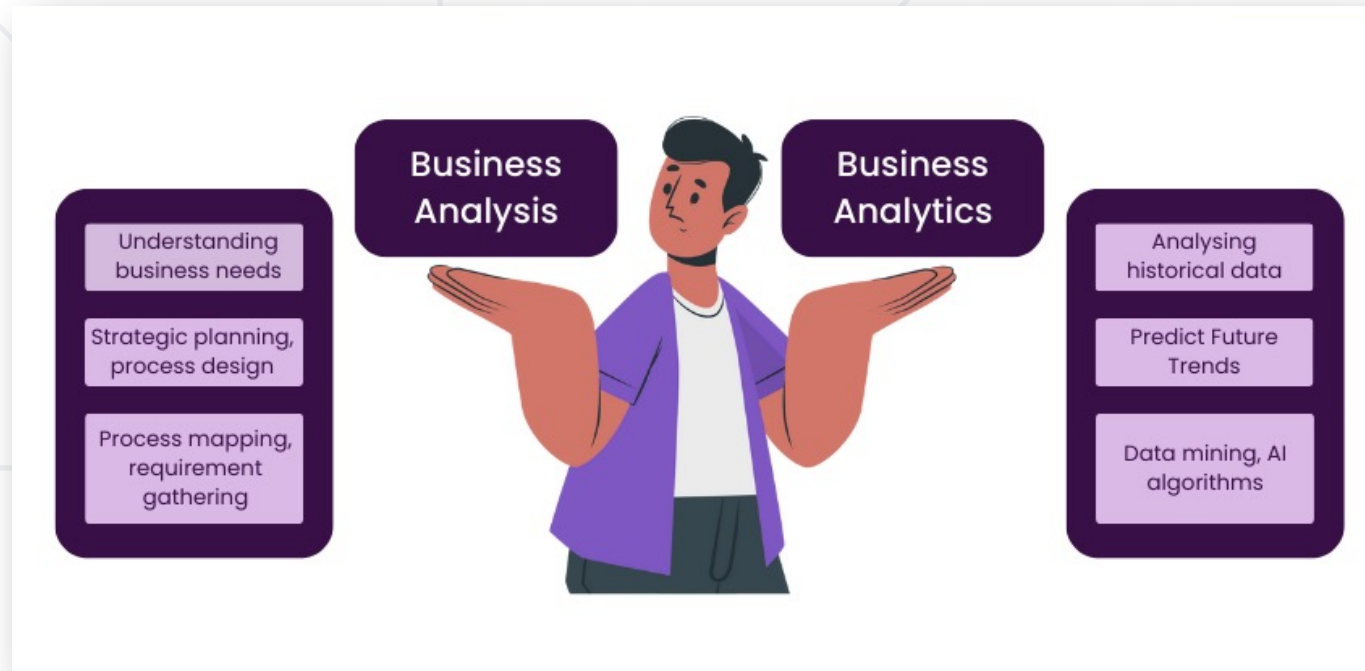
- **Lack of domain knowledge:** Analysts often work across various domains, and a lack of expertise in a specific area can hinder their understanding of business requirements.
- **Evolving business needs:** Analysts must adapt quickly to evolving requirements and expectations as businesses grow and markets change.
- **Communication gaps:** Effective communication is key in BA, but differences in language, culture, or technical understanding can create significant barriers.
- **Resistance to change:** Stakeholders may resist changes proposed by analysts, especially if they alter established workflows or require new skill sets.
- **Complex stakeholder management:** Balancing the conflicting interests of various stakeholders while aligning with business objectives is a delicate task.

These **Business Analysis Challenges** require analysts to be adaptable, communicative, and knowledgeable about the business and its broader context.





What is the difference?



Business Analysis (BA) and Business Analytics (BA) are distinct disciplines that play crucial roles in organizational success.

- Business Analysis focuses on **understanding business needs**, **facilitating change**, and **ensuring solutions** align with strategic goals
- Business Analytics uses **statistical methods** and **technologies** to analyze historical data and generate insights for strategic decision-making



What is the difference?

Product Owner

The **Product Owner**:

- has a **vision of the product** keeping the domain / industry experience and the market need.
- ensure that the **product meets** the market and stakeholder **needs**
- conduct market analysis followed by an enterprise **SWOT analysis** to come up with the product vision
- works on the **go-to-market strategy** for the product
- tries to leverage their experience in the domain, **need of the market**, the industry or the domain, the organization's market position, and the **customer expectation** of the product



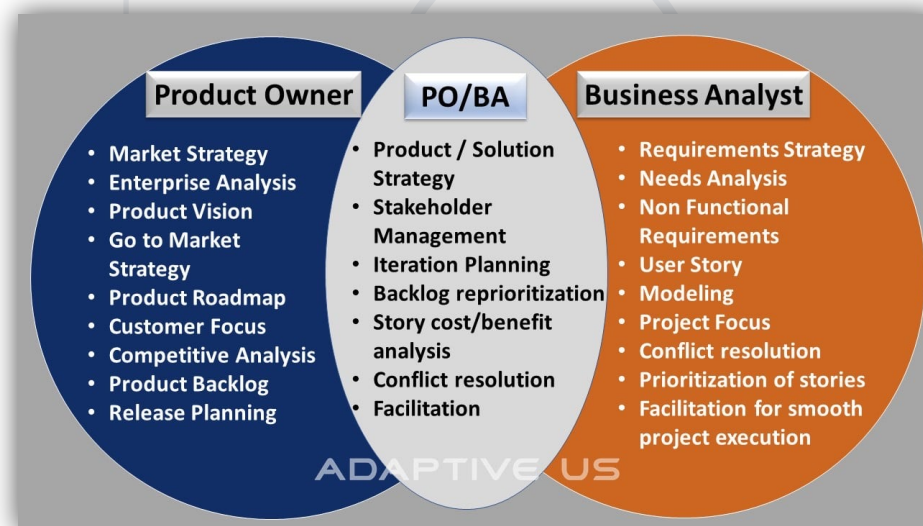
Critical Responsibilities for Product Owner



- **Market Analysis**
- **Enterprise Analysis**
- **Product Vision and Roadmap**
- **Go to Market Strategy**
- **Managing Product Features**
- **Managing Product Backlog**
- **Managing Overall Iteration Progress**

Business Analyst

- The **Business Analyst** role supports the Product Owner in delivering detailed artifacts
- Often the Business Analyst is **considered a Proxy Product Owner**
- This allows the Agile team to have a higher amount **of access to the Product Owner's perspectives**



Critical Responsibilities for Business Analysts

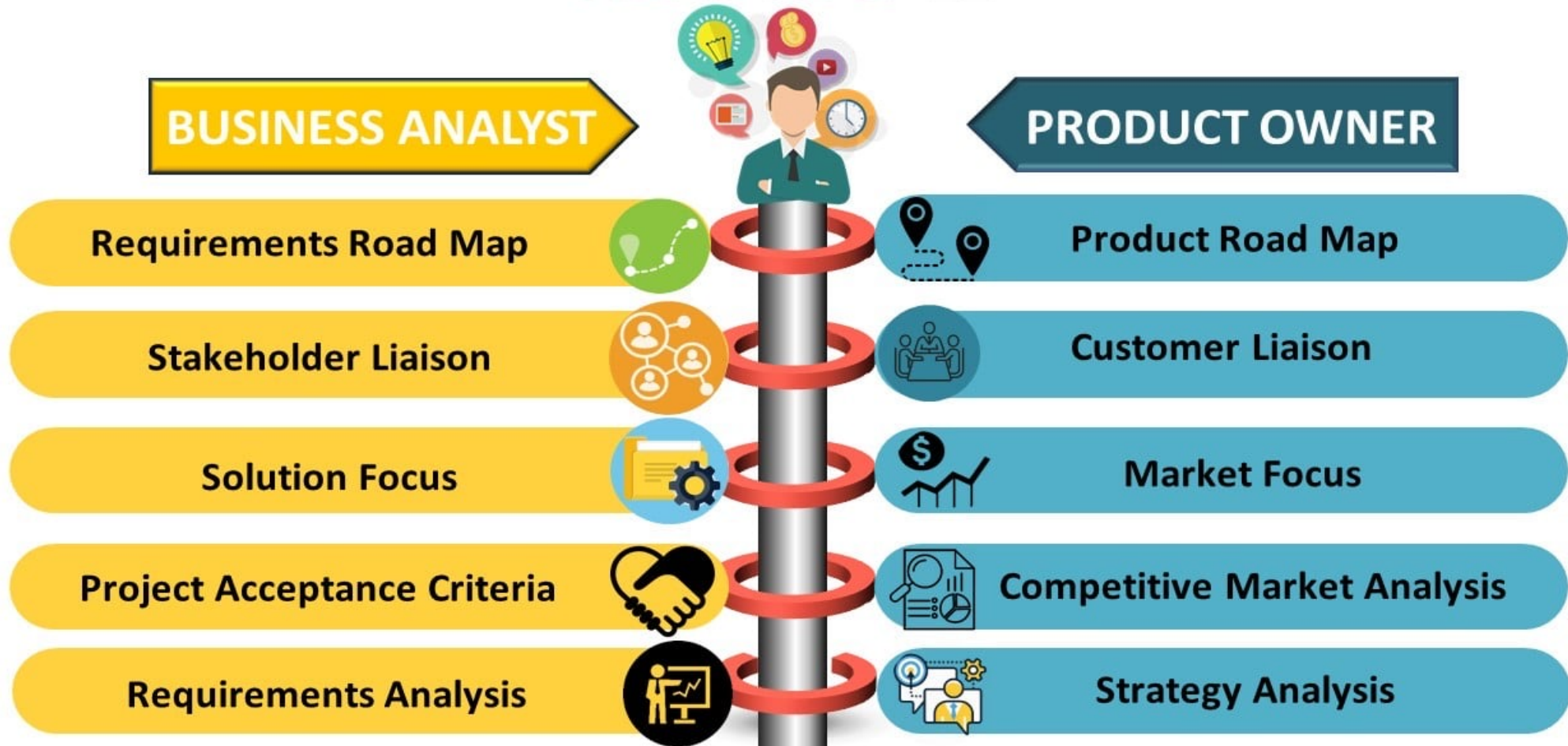
- **Managing User Stories**
- **Detailing the Requirements as per the Stakeholders' Needs and Expectations**
- **Clarifying the details of requirements with stakeholders**
- **Impact Analysis for Changes**
- **Work closely with the PO on the Sprint Execution**



Business Analyst vs Product Owner

BUSINESS ANALYST vs PRODUCT OWNER

ADAPTIVE US





Practice

What is a Business Analysis?

- a) A practice that is applicable only in IT industry
- b) A practice of enabling change in an enterprise by defining needs and recommending solutions that deliver value to the stakeholders
- c) A practice that connects business users to IT specialist and allows them to communicate easily



What is a Business Analysis?

- 
- a) A practice that is applicable only in IT industry
 - b) A practice of enabling change in an enterprise by defining needs and recommending solutions that deliver value to the stakeholders
 - c) A practice that connects business users to IT specialist and allows them to communicate easily

What is a Business Ecosystem?

- 
- a) A systematically ordered companies that are connected between each other
 - b) Business units that cooperates with external business units and do business together
 - c) A network of organizations—including **suppliers, distributors, customers, competitors, government agencies**, and so on—involved in the delivery of a specific product or service through both competition and cooperation

What is a Business Ecosystem?

- 
- a) A systematically ordered companies that are connected between each other
 - b) Business units that cooperates with external business units and do business together
 - c) A network of organizations—including **suppliers, distributors, customers, competitors, government agencies**, and so on—involved in the delivery of a specific product or service through both competition and cooperation



Root Cause Analysis

What is RCA?

- Root cause analysis is a **systematic examination of a problem** or situation that focuses on the problem's origin as the proper point of correction rather than dealing only with its effects
- Root cause analysis looks at the main types of causes such as **people** (human error, lack of training), **physical** (equipment failure, poor facility), or **organizational** (faulty process design, poor structure)



What is RCA?

- Root cause analysis can be used for:
 - Reactive Analysis: identifying the root cause(s) of an occurring problem for corrective action
 - Proactive Analysis: identifying potential problem areas for preventive action



Root Cause Analysis Steps

1. Specify the problem situation

2. Understand the problem situation –
check each aspect of the problem

3. Take prompt action steps

4. Take preventative action steps

5. Establish the solution



The 5 WHYs

- The five whys is a question **asking process to explore** the nature and cause of a problem
- The five whys approach **repeatedly asks questions** in an attempt to get to the root cause of the problem
- This is one of the **simplest facilitation tools** to use when problems have a human interaction component



The 5 WHYs

To use this technique:

Step 1. Write the problem on a flip chart or whiteboard.

Step 2. Ask "Why do you think this problem occurs?" and capture the idea below the problem.

Step 3. Ask "Why?" again and capture that idea below the first idea. Continue with step 3 until you are convinced the actual root cause has been identified. This may take more or less than five questions—the technique is called the five whys because it often takes that many to reach the root cause, not because the question must be asked five times.





Practice

1. Why do we do business analysis in IT?

- To ensure that IT solutions align with business needs and objectives

2. Why must IT solutions align with business needs and objectives?

- Because misalignment can lead to wasted resources and solutions that do not support the company's strategic direction

3. Why would misalignment lead to wasted resources?

- Because projects that do not align with business objectives may not be used to their full potential, or may need to be reworked or replaced

4. Why would projects not be used to their full potential, or need reworking or replacing?

- Because they may not meet the actual needs of the users or may be technologically outdated by the time they are completed

5. Why might projects not meet the actual needs of the users or be outdated?

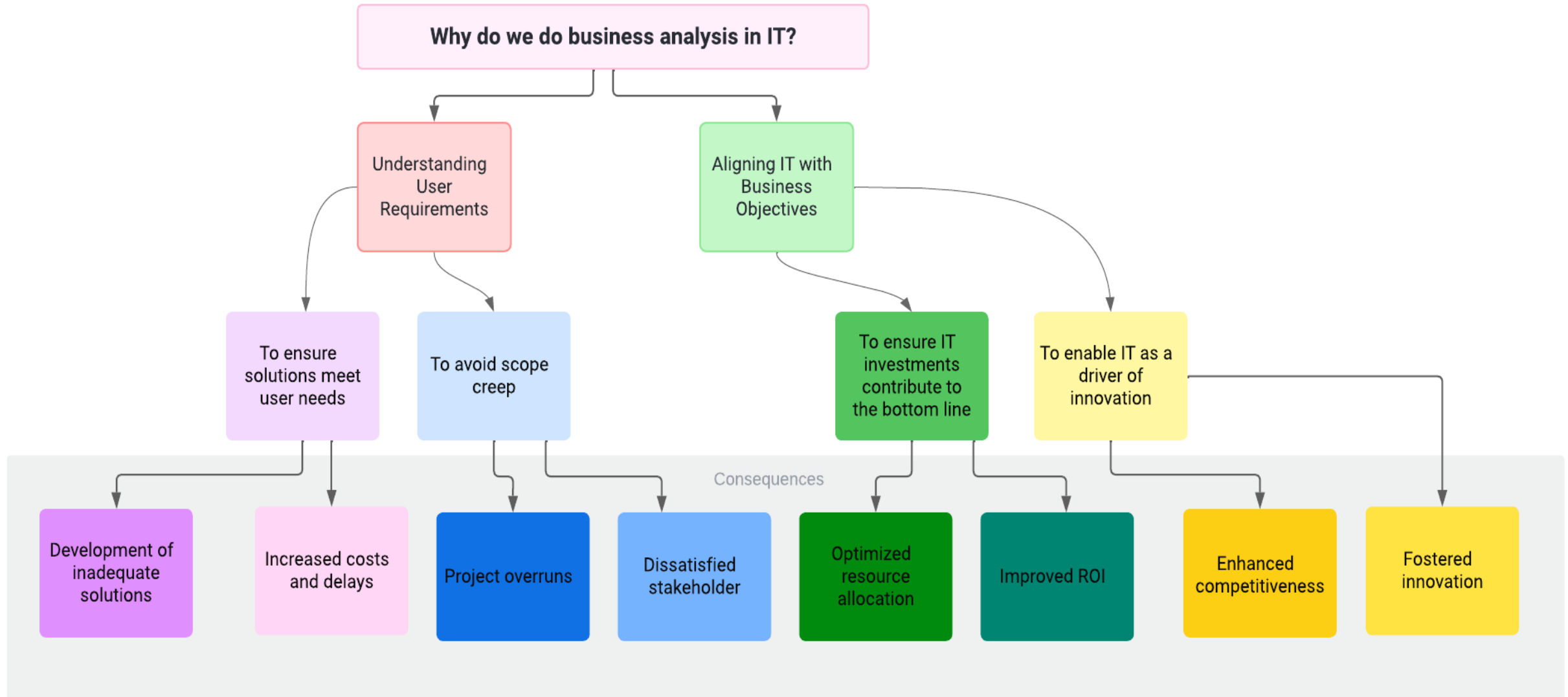
- Because without thorough business analysis, there is a risk of insufficient requirement gathering, poor stakeholder engagement, and not keeping pace with rapidly changing technology trends

Make a 5 WHYs Root Cause Analysis on the following problem:

"Bulgaria's road network is poor condition in Europe!"



Why Business Analysis? Root Cause Analysis



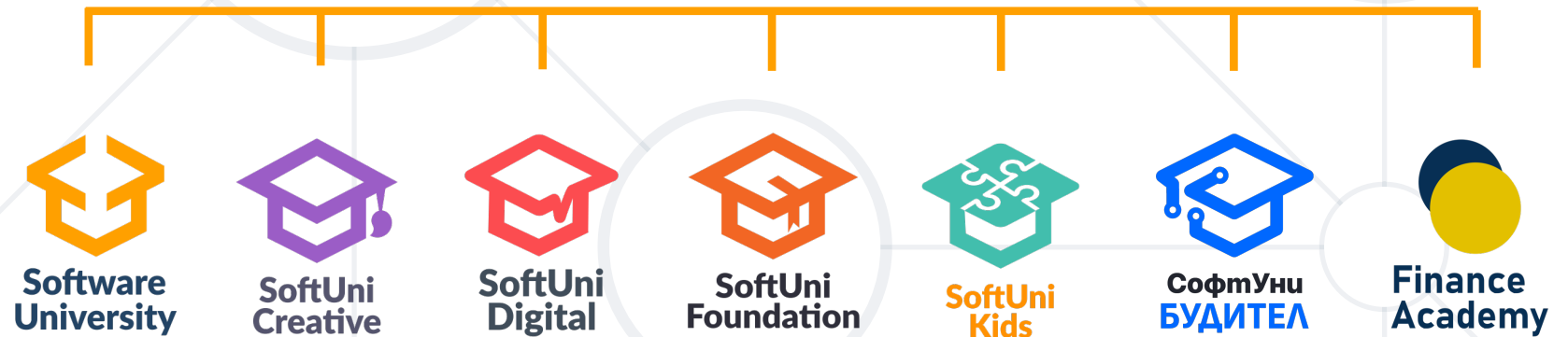
1. [The knowledge academy](#)
2. [IIBA Website – BABOK guide V3](#)
3. Udemy – [RCA course](#)



- Business and Ecosystem
- What is Business Analysis?
- Who is the Business Analyst?
- Business Analysis Challenges
- Root Cause Analysis



Questions?



SoftUni Diamond Partners



- Software University – High-Quality Education, Profession and Job for Software Developers
 - softuni.bg, about.softuni.bg
- Software University Foundation
 - softuni.foundation
- Software University @ Facebook
 - facebook.com/SoftwareUniversity



- This course (slides, examples, demos, exercises, homework, documents, videos and other assets) is copyrighted content
- Unauthorized copy, reproduction or use is illegal
- © SoftUni – <https://about.softuni.bg/>
- © Software University – <https://softuni.bg>

